

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk It fails when you answer the objection you guessed at instead of clarifying the real concern

THE MOVE

Cue -> Pause -> Clarify -> Name -> Check -> Respond. -> Cue: notice the objection without treating it as a threat. -> **Pause:** resist the reflex to explain or rebut. -> **Clarify:** ask one short neutral question about the real concern. -> **Name:** reflect t...

START HERE

When resistance appears, ask one short neutral question — "What part of that is the main concern?" — then pause and listen before you respond.

SAY THIS

Quick openers	<i>"What part of that is the main concern?"</i>
Soft and warm	<i>"Help me understand what feels off about it."</i>
Work and decisions	<i>"Is your concern mainly about risk, timing, cost, or something else?"</i>
Two-option questions	<i>"Is the concern the risk itself, or the confidence that we can manage it?"</i>
Complaints and repair	<i>"Is the frustrating part the outcome, the delay, or how it was communicated?"</i>
Boundary and high-p...	<i>"You don't have to justify the no. If it's useful, I'd like to understand which concern matters most."</i>

AVOID

- They have already given a clear, final no or boundary
- The moment calls for an apology, not more questions
- Safety, privacy, or immediate practical help matters more

REMEMBER

Don't answer the first shape of the objection — clarify the concern underneath it.